Managing Safety and Health Programs

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Agenda

Introduction

Core Elements of Safety and Health Programs

Methods to Prevent/Control Hazards

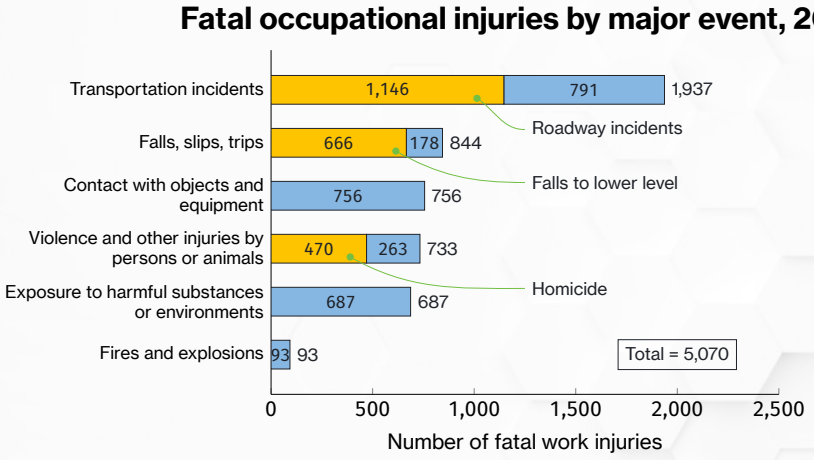
Objectives

1. Recognize the cost of workplace accidents
2. Recognize the benefits of implementing an effective safety and health program
3. Describe the elements of an effective safety and health program
4. Identify three methods to prevent workplace hazards

Introduction



Fatal Occupational Injuries



Source: U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics

Costs of Accidents

Direct Costs:

- Cost of treatment
- Cost of doctor/hospital
- Cost of medications
- Cost of medical equipment

Indirect Costs:

- Schedule delays
- Lower morale
- Increased absenteeism
- Poor customer relations
- Re-training

Benefits of Safety and Health Programs

- Improvement in product, process, and service quality
- Better morale
- Improved recruiting and retention
- More favorable image and reputation

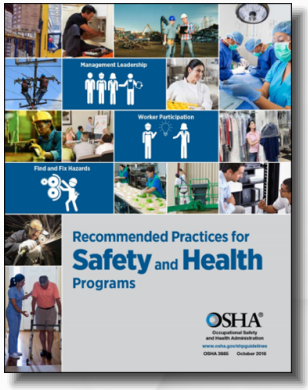


Image: U.S. Occupational Safety and Health Administration (OSHA)

OSHA Recommended Practices for Safety and Health Programs

Core Elements of Safety and Health Programs



Core Elements of Safety and Health Programs

There are 7 core elements to an effective safety and health program:

1. Management Leadership
2. Worker Participation
3. Hazard Identification and Assessment
4. Hazard Prevention and Control
5. Education and Training
6. Program Evaluation and Improvement
7. Coordination and Communication on Multiemployer Worksites

Core Elements of Safety and Health Programs

Management Leadership



Management Leadership

- Owners, CEOs, managers, supervisors at all levels
- Provide the leadership, vision, resources needed implement an effective safety and health program

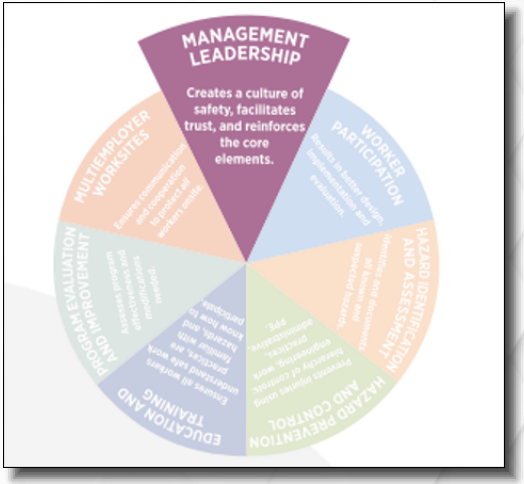


Image: U.S. Occupational Safety and Health Administration

Leadership Action Items (1 of 4)

Action Item 1

Communicate your commitment to Safety and Health Programs

How to accomplish it:

- Establish a written safety and health policy signed by top management
- Communicate the policy to workers, contractors, unions, suppliers, visitors, etc.

Management Leadership (2 of 4)

Action Item 2

Define program goals and expectations

How to accomplish it:

- Establish realistic, attainable, and measurable goals that demonstrate progress toward improving safety and health
- Develop safety and health plans

Management Leadership (3 of 4)

Action Item 3

Allocate resources

How to accomplish it:

- Integrate safety and health into planning and budgeting
- Allow time in workers' schedule for participation

Management Leadership (4 of 4)

Action Item 4

Expect performance

How to accomplish it:

- Define and communicate responsibilities and authorities for accountability
- Set an example for workers by following the same procedures

Core Elements of Safety and Health Programs

Worker Participation

Worker Participation

- Workers gain the most from a successful program
- Also lose the most if it fails...

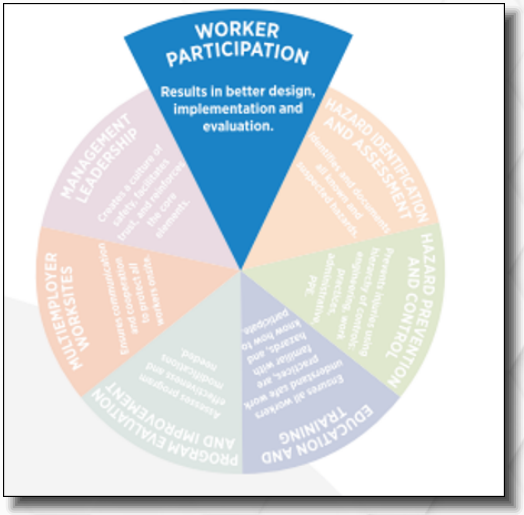


Image: U.S. Occupational Safety and Health Administration

Participating in Safety Programs

All workers, including contractors, subcontractors, temp workers:

- Have opportunities to participate throughout program design and implementation
- Have access to information they need to participate effectively in the program
- Are encouraged to participate in the program
- Feel comfortable reporting safety and health concerns

Safety Incentives (1 of 2)

How many of your workplaces have these as part of your safety and health plan?

- Incentive programs that tie evaluation, compensation, or rewards to low injury/illness rates
- Point systems that penalize for reporting injuries, illnesses, or other safety or health concerns
- Mandatory drug testing after reporting injuries?

Safety Incentives (2 of 2)

All of those are pretty terrible ideas.

- When compensation is tied to reporting it **discourages** reporting and does nothing for safety
- Likewise for drug testing
- Effective safety and health programs recognize positive safety activities

Worker Action Item 1

Encourage workers to report safety and health concerns

How to accomplish it:

- Establish a process for reporting
- Respond promptly
- Consider anonymity
- Empower workers to suspend or shut down an activity they feel is unsafe
- Involve workers in finding solutions
- Emphasize management will only use the information for improvement – **NOT** retaliation

Worker Action Item 2

Encourage workers to participate in the program

How to accomplish it:

- Acknowledge and provide positive reinforcement to workers who actively participate
- Maintain an open door policy that invites workers to talk to management about safety and health
- Encourage workers to make suggestions about safety and health
- Encourage contractors and temps to participate

Worker Action Item 3

Involve workers in all aspects of the program

How to accomplish it:

- Developing the program
- Reporting hazards and developing solutions
- Analyze hazards in each step of each job
- Define/document safe work practices
- Conducting site inspections
- Developing/revising safety procedures
- Participating in incident investigations
- Serving as trainers for coworkers and new hires
- Developing, implementing, evaluating training programs

Worker Action Item 4

Give workers access to safety and health information

How to accomplish it:

- Safety Data Sheets
- Injury/illness data
- Results of environmental exposure monitoring
- Chemical/equipment manufacturer safety information
- Workplace inspection reports
- Incident investigation reports
- Workplace job hazard analyses

Worker Action Item 5

Remove barriers to participation

How to accomplish it:

- Ensure workers from all levels can participate regardless of:
  - Skill level
  - Education
  - Language
- Ensure other policies/programs do not discourage participation
- Authorize resources to encourage participation (e.g. meetings during working hours)

Core Elements of Safety and Health Programs

Hazard Identification and Assessment



Hazard Identification and Assessment

- Failure to identify hazards is one of the common “root causes”
- Leads to opportunities to improve program performance



Image: U.S. Occupational Safety and Health Administration (OSHA)

Hazard Identification Action Item 1

Collect existing information about workplace hazards

How to accomplish it:

- Collect, organize, review hazard information
  - What types are present
  - Which workers may be exposed

Sources of Information

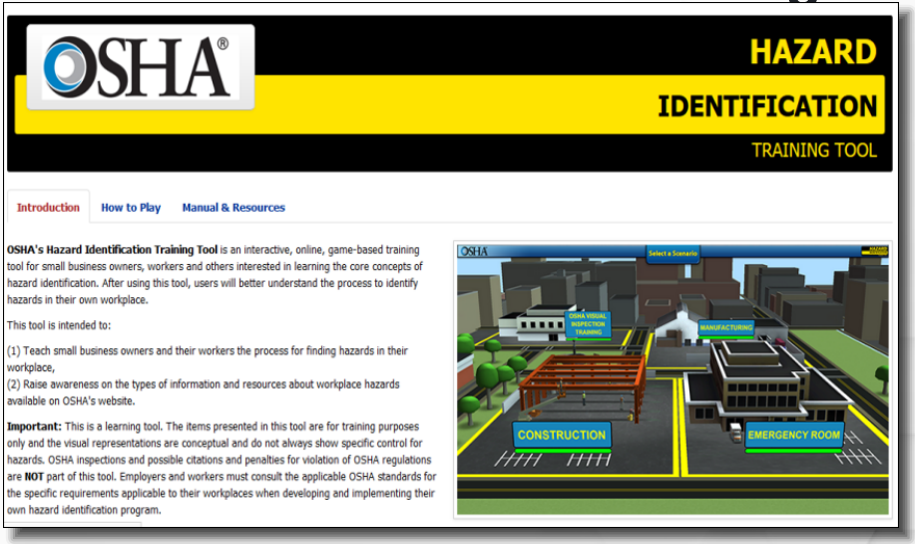
Inside Sources

- Equipment operating manuals
- Safety data sheets
- Inspection reports from insurance, government, consultants
- Previous injury/illness logs
- Results of medical reports
- Input from workers

Outside Sources

- Existing safety and health programs
- OSHA websites
- Trade associations
- Safety and health consultants

OSHA Hazard Identification Training Tool



OSHA Hazard Identification Training Tool

Hazard Identification Action Item 2 (1 of 2)

Inspect the workplace

How to accomplish it:

- Conduct regular inspections
  - Observe workflow
  - Inspect equipment/materials
  - Talk with workers
- Document inspection
- Include ancillary activities in inspections
  - Facilities and maintenance
  - Purchasing and office
  - Contractor and temp activities

Hazard Identification Action Item 2 (2 of 2)

Inspect the workplace

How to accomplish it:

- Use checklists to highlight common hazards
- Make sure to conduct a hazard review **BEFORE implementing changes**

Hazard Identification Action Item 3 (1 of 2)

Conduct incident investigations

How to accomplish it:

- Develop a procedure so investigation can start immediately after incident
  - Who will be involved
  - Lines of communication
  - Material, equipment, supplies needed
  - Reporting forms/templates
- Investigation team should include management **AND workers**
- Train teams in investigation techniques, remaining objective, open mindset

Hazard Identification Action Item 3 (2 of 2)

Conduct incident investigations

How to accomplish it:

- Investigate close calls/near misses
- Caused by the same conditions that cause injuries/illnesses
- Signal that hazards have been missed/new hazards are present
- Make sure procedures encourage reporting

Responding to an Incident

- Prevent additional incidents
- Provide first-aid
- Report incident to authorities
- Interview witnesses
- Preserve the scene
- Collect physical evidence
- Assemble all evidence
- Document findings and recommendations
- Develop corrective action plan
- Communicate the results to affected workers and supervisors for training

Hazard Identification Action Item 4

Identify hazards associated with emergency and non-routine situations

How to accomplish it:

- Fires/explosions
- Hazardous material spills
- Startups after equipment shutdowns
- Infrequent maintenance activities
- Natural disasters

Hazard Identification Action Item 5

Characterize the nature of identified hazards, determine the controls to be implemented, and prioritize the hazards for control

How to accomplish it:

- Evaluate each hazard
  - Severity
  - Exposure
  - Avoidance
- Prioritize hazards according to risk
- Use interim measures to protect workers until permanent solutions can be implemented

Core Elements of Safety and Health Programs

Hazard Prevention and Control



Hazard Prevention and Control

- Prevent injuries, illnesses, incidents
- Help provide workers safe and healthy working conditions
- Used to prevent/control hazards from the previous assessment



Image: U.S. Occupational Safety and Health Administration (OSHA)

Hazard Prevention and Control Action Item 1

Identify control options

How to accomplish it:

- Review existing sources:
  - Manufacturer literature
  - OSHA standards
  - Industry standards
  - NIOSH publications
  - Engineering reports
- Investigate control measures in other workplaces
- Get input from workers
- Consult with safety and health experts for complex hazards

Hazard Prevention and Control Action Item 2

Select controls

How to accomplish it:

- Plan to eliminate or control all serious hazards
- Use interim controls where necessary
- Select controls based on the hierarchy of controls
- Use a combination of controls when no single method fully protects workers
- Consider how controls may impact training needs

Hazard Prevention and Control Action Item 3

Develop *and update* a hazard control plan

How to accomplish it:

- List hazards in order of priority
- Assign responsibility to a specific person with power to implement controls
- Establish target date
- Plan how to track progress
- Plan how you will verify effectiveness

Hazard Prevention and Control Action Item 4

Select controls to protect workers during non-routine operations and emergencies

How to accomplish it:

- Develop procedures to control non-routine hazards
- Develop procedures to control emergency hazards
- Procure any equipment to control emergency hazards
- Assign responsibility for implementing emergency plan
- Conduct emergency drills

Hazard Prevention and Control Action Item 5

Implement selected controls in the workplace

How to accomplish it:

- Implement according to priority
- “Worst-first”
- Quick fixes – housekeeping, trip hazards, lighting

Hazard Prevention and Control Action Item 6

Follow up to confirm that controls are effective

How to accomplish it:

- Conduct regular inspections to confirm controls are operating
- Confirm work practices, administrative controls, and PPE policies are being followed
- Conduct PM

Hazard Control Follow-up Questions

- Have all controls been implemented on schedule?
- Have engineering controls been properly installed and tested?
- Have workers been adequately trained so they understand the controls?
- Are controls being used correctly and consistently?

Core Elements of Safety and Health Programs

Education and Training



Education and Training

Employers, managers, supervisors, workers:

- Have the knowledge and skills needed to work safely and avoid creating hazards
- Demonstrate awareness and understanding of hazards
- Receive special training when work involves unique hazards

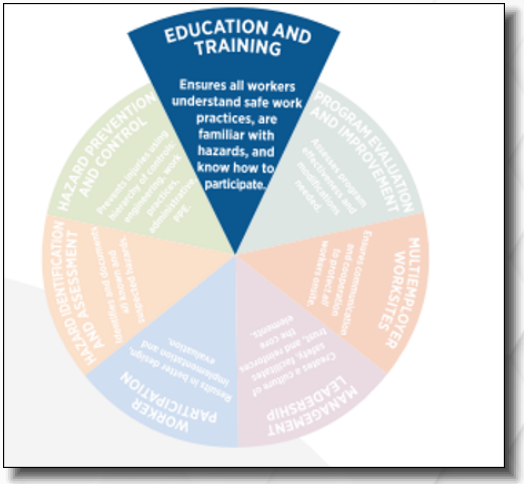


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Core Elements of Safety and Health Programs

Program Evaluation and Improvement



Program Evaluation and Improvement

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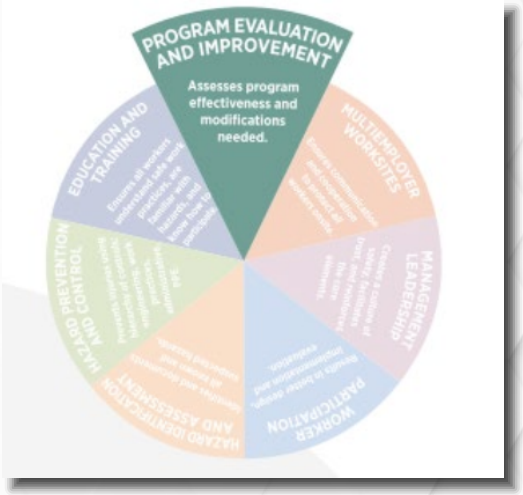


Image: U.S. Occupational Safety and Health Administration (OSHA)

Program Evaluation Action Item 1

Verify the program is implemented and operating

How to accomplish it:

- Verify the core elements of the program are fully met and key processes are in place and implemented
- Are controls being used correctly and consistently?
- Verify:
  - Injuries are being reported
  - Inspections are conducted
  - Progress is being tracked

Program Evaluation Action Item 2

Correct program deficiencies and identify opportunities to improve

How to accomplish it:

- Seek input
  - Managers
  - Workers
  - Supervisors
  - Other stakeholders
- Are the metrics/goals still relevant?
- How can we change them to be more effective?

Core Elements of Safety and Health Programs

Multiemployer Worksites



Multiemployer Worksites

- Multiemployer site = contractors that don't work for you
- A good safety program involves **everyone**
- All contractors/temps/**everyone should be involved in all previous steps**



Image: U.S. Occupational Safety and Health Administration (OSHA)

Methods to Prevent/Control Hazards

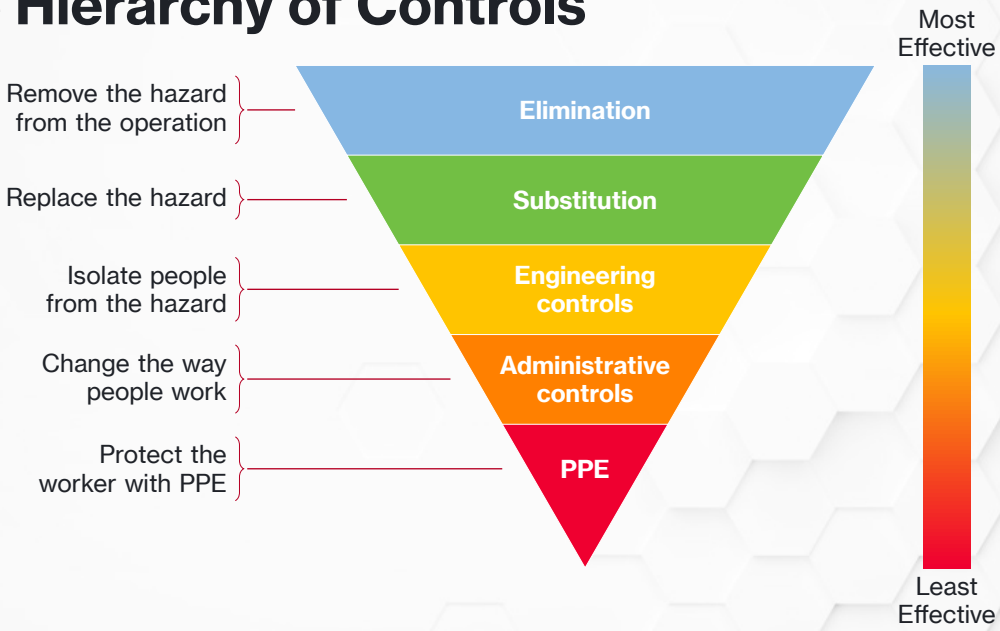


Methods to Prevent/Control Hazards

INVOLVE WORKERS!

- Understand the conditions that create the hazard
- Insights into how hazards can be controlled

The Hierarchy of Controls



Points to Remember

- Hazard control plan
- Remember to include emergencies/non-routine activities
- Continuously evaluate effectiveness of controls
- Continuously evaluate new technologies

Questions?

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